

Class 9 Social Science (Geography) Chapter: Shaping the Earth

Introduction

The Earth is continuously changing due to internal and external forces. These processes create and modify landforms.

Internal Forces

Originate inside the Earth. They cause earthquakes, volcanic eruptions, folding and faulting, leading to the formation of mountains and plateaus.

External Forces

Work on the Earth's surface. Weathering, erosion and deposition by rivers, wind, glaciers and sea waves shape the land.

Weathering

Breaking down of rocks into smaller pieces due to temperature, water, wind and living organisms.

Erosion

Removal of weathered material by running water, wind, glaciers and sea waves.

Deposition

The laying down of eroded materials, forming plains, deltas and beaches.

Major Landforms

Mountains, Plateaus and Plains are the major landforms of the Earth.

Importance

Landforms influence agriculture, climate, transport, settlement and human activities.

Key Terms

Weathering, Erosion, Deposition, Volcano, Earthquake, Fold Mountains, Plateau, Plain.

Quick Revision

- Internal forces build landforms.
- External forces wear them down and reshape them.
- Rivers create valleys and deltas.
- Wind forms sand dunes.
- Glaciers carve U-shaped valleys.